OFFICE OF THE UNIVERSITY REGISTRAR & ACADEMIC SENATE

ACADEMIC QUALITY ASSURANCE, EXAMINATIONS & STUDENT WELFARE GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

ACADEMIC PROGRESSION REGULATIONS & STUDENT HANDBOOK

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Effective Date:	01 September 2023 (Section 5 Partially Superseded 01 Jan 2025)	**Supersedes:**	2021 Undergraduate Student Handbook v1.5
Approving Body:	Academic Progression Board & Office of Student Affairs	**Linked Policies:**	Overridden in part by POL-ACAD-EX-01, POL-ACAD-AT-02, POL-ACAD-CW-03, POL-MED-WF-04

SECTION 1: GOVERNANCE OF ACADEMIC PROGRESSION AND ORDER OF PRECEDENCE

Clause 1.1 (Scope of Progression Regulations): This handbook governs annual credit progression across Honours degree levels (Level 4, Level 5, Level 6, and Level 7), integrated multi-issue medical case management, GPA protection during deferred assessments, and Temporary Medical Intercalation (Suspension of Studies). Sections 1 through 4 remain in full statutory force.

Clause 1.2 (Statutory Rule of Precedence — 2025 Policies Override Section 5 Legacy Summaries): Where any operational deadline, percentage threshold, or documentation rule printed in **Section 5 (Legacy 2023 Administrative Summary)** of this Handbook conflicts with a specialized **2025 Senate Policy Revision** (`POL-ACAD-EX-01` v4.0, `POL-ACAD-AT-02` v3.2, `POL-ACAD-CW-03` v3.0, or `POL-MED-WF-04` v3.5), the **2025 Senate Policy takes absolute legal precedence**.

PROGRESSION & CASE DEFINITIONS (PART A)

- **Multi-Issue Medical Case (Form PRG-05-CASE):** Consolidated advisory protocol when a single hospitalization affects Examinations, Attendance, and Coursework simultaneously.
- **Standard Progression Threshold:** Minimum 90 earned credits out of 120 annual credits required to advance to the next degree level.
- **Pending Medical Credits ('I-Med'):** Credits awaiting Supplementary Deferred Examinations; treated as non-penalized pending credits.

PROGRESSION & CASE DEFINITIONS (PART B)

- **30-Credit Deferred Cap:** Maximum pending 'I-Med' credits permitted for provisional progression; exceeding 30 credits triggers Medical Intercalation.
- **Medical Intercalation (Form PRG-05-INT):** Authorized pause of studies for 1–2 semesters due to prolonged illness (>21 teaching days or <65% attendance).
- **Fit-to-Return Certificate (Form MED-RTN-06):** Mandatory CMO medical clearance required 14 days prior to resuming studies after intercalation.

SECTION 2: INTEGRATED MULTI-ISSUE ACADEMIC CASE RESOLUTION PROTOCOL

Clause 2.1 (Connecting Examination, Attendance, and Coursework Policies for Hospitalized Students): When a student suffers a major medical event such as a **ten-day (10-day) inpatient hospitalization** near the end of a teaching semester, multiple academic regulations are triggered simultaneously: (1) a missed final examination (`POL-ACAD-EX-01`), (2) a drop in cumulative module attendance (`POL-ACAD-AT-02`), and (3) a missed coursework deadline during hospitalization (`POL-ACAD-CW-03`).

Clause 2.2 (Consolidated Case Advisory Workflow — Form PRG-05-CASE): Rather than navigating each department in isolation, a hospitalized student facing two or more concurrent academic issues must initiate the **Consolidated Medical Case Protocol** by following the unified 6-step sequence in Table 2.1 below.

Table 2.1: Step-by-Step Integrated Action Plan for a Student Hospitalized for 10 Days (Multi-Policy Synthesis)

Step & Timeline	Administrative Action Required	Forms & Documents Required	Target Office / Portal	Governing Policy & Clause
Step 1: Within 48 Hours of Missed Exam	Submit initial digital absence alert (by student or next-of-kin if still in ward)	Online EC Alert + Scan of Hospital Admission Note	Student Academic Portal (EC Module) or `exams.welfare@university.edu`	POL-ACAD-EX-01 Clause 3.1 & POL-MED-WF-04 Clause 4.1
Step 2: Upon Hospital Discharge (Day 1)	Collect complete Inpatient Hospitalization Dossier before leaving hospital	1) Admission & Discharge Ticket, 2) Ward Consultant Summary, 3) SLMC Medical Certificate	Hospital Ward Registrar / Records Office	POL-MED-WF-04 Clause 3.1 & Clause 3.2 (Table 3.1)
Step 3: Within 3 Working Days of Discharge	Authenticate medical dossier at UMC AND file Retrospective Tier-3 Coursework Extension	Obtain Form MED-04-CLR at UMC -> Submit Form EXT-03C + Discharge Ticket on LMS	1) UMC (Building B, G-Floor) 2) Faculty EC Panel / LMS Portal	POL-MED-WF-04 Clause 4.2 & POL-ACAD-CW-03 Clause 2.3, 3.2 (8–14 day extension)
Step 4: Within 5 Working Days of Discharge	File Formal Deferred Exam Application ('I-Med' Uncapped First-Sit)	Form EC-01 + Original Form MED-04-CLR + Hospital Discharge Summary + Exam Timetable	Examinations Division Counter (Admin Block, Level 2, Room 204)	POL-ACAD-EX-01 Clause 3.2 & Clause 5.1
Step 5: Within 5 Working Days of Discharge	File Attendance Condonation (70–79% HoD Track or 65–69% Dean Waiver Track) + Lab Make-Up	Form ATT-02A or Form ATT-02B + Form LAB-MK-01 + Copy of Form MED-04-CLR	Faculty Academic Admin Office (Level 1, Room F-102)	POL-ACAD-AT-02 Clause 2.2, Clause 3.1 & Clause 4.2
Step 6: Case Registration & Follow-Up	Register Consolidated Case Summary to protect GPA & coordinate Supplementary Exam schedule	Form PRG-05-CASE (links Exam, Attendance & CW approvals)	Student Welfare Directorate (Student Center, Suite 108)	HBK-ACAD-PR-05 Clause 2.2 & Clause 3.2

SECTION 3: ANNUAL CREDIT PROGRESSION, 'I-MED' CREDITS, AND GPA PROTECTION

Clause 3.1 (Standard 90-Credit Progression Rule): Each academic year comprises **120 credits** across two semesters. To progress unconditionally from one academic year (Level) to the next, a student must earn a minimum of **90 passed credits** with a Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) of at least **2.00**, and may trail no more than **30 failed/repeat credits**.

Clause 3.2 (Treatment of Approved 'I-Med' Deferred Credits): Modules assigned an approved `I-Med` (Deferred Examination) or `I-Med-CW` (Deferred Coursework) grade are classified as **Pending Non-Penalized Credits**. They are excluded from the GPA denominator until the Supplementary Assessment is completed, preventing any artificial drop in the student's CGPA or Dean's List / Honours classification eligibility.

Clause 3.3 (Provisional Progression vs. 30-Credit Pending Limit): A student holding up to **30 credits of pending `I-Med` assessments** (provided they have passed at least 90 credits or hold 90 combined passed + `I-Med` credits) is granted *Provisional Progression* into the next academic year pending completion of the Supplementary Examination Window. If a student's unresolved `I-Med` plus failed credits exceed **30 credits** after the Supplementary Window, the student cannot progress to the next level and must enter a *Part-Time Progression Plan* or *Medical Intercalation*.

Table 3.1: Annual Credit Progression & Academic Standing Decision Matrix (120-Credit Academic Year)

Earned Credits	Pending 'I-Med' Credits	Failed Credits	Progression Outcome	Administrative Conditions & Honours Impact
120 Credits	0 Credits	0 Credits	Unconditional Progression	Full progression; eligible for Dean's List & First-Class Honours
90 – 105 Credits	15 – 30 Credits	0 Credits	Provisional Medical Progression	Advances to next Level; sits Uncapped First-Sit in Supplementary Window; Honours unaffected
90 Credits	0 Credits	30 Credits	Conditional Progression (Trailing)	Advances to next Level; must Resit 30 failed credits (capped at 40% Pass)
60 – 75 Credits	45 – 60 Credits	0 Credits	Progression Hold until Supplementary Exam	Must clear 'I-Med' exams in Supplementary Window to reach >= 90 earned credits
< 90 Credits post-Supp	> 30 Credits	Any	Mandatory Level Repeat or Intercalation	Cannot advance to next degree Level until pending/failed modules are cleared

SECTION 4: TEMPORARY MEDICAL INTERCALATION (SUSPENSION OF STUDIES) & RETURN PROTOCOL

Clause 4.1 (When Medical Intercalation is Mandatory): A student must apply for *Temporary Medical Intercalation (Form PRG-05-INT)* where: (a) a severe medical illness or surgery requires absence exceeding **twenty-one (21) consecutive teaching days**; (b) module attendance drops below the **65.0% hard regulatory floor** (`POL-ACAD-AT-02` Clause 3.2); or (c) the student is medically unfit to sit both the Main and Supplementary Examination Windows.

Clause 4.2 (Financial and Academic Protections During Intercalation): Approved Medical Intercalation freezes the student's academic registration for one or two semesters without academic penalty. Tuition fees already paid for the interrupted semester are credited **100% forward** to the resumption semester. Prior to returning to campus, the student must submit a *Fit-to-Return Medical Clearance Certificate (Form MED-RTN-06)* endorsed by the University CMO at least **fourteen (14) calendar days** before the start of the resumption semester.

SECTION 5: LEGACY 2023 ADMINISTRATIVE SUMMARY (SUBJECT TO 2025 SENATE SUPERSESSION)

CRITICAL GOVERNANCE NOTICE FOR SECTION 5 (LEGACY 2023 CLAUSES)
The clauses below (Clauses 5.1 to 5.5) are retained from the 2023 Edition of the Student Handbook (v1.8) for historical cohort reference ONLY. Pursuant to Clause 1.2, every parameter in Section 5 below has been SUPERSEDED and OVERRIDDEN for the 2025 academic year by Policies POL-ACAD-EX-01 (v4.0), POL-ACAD-AT-02 (v3.2), POL-ACAD-CW-03 (v3.0), and POL-MED-WF-04 (v3.5).

Clause 5.1 [LEGACY 2023 RULE — SUPERSEDED BY POL-ACAD-EX-01 Clause 3.2]: Under the 2023 Handbook rules, a student who missed a final examination due to illness was permitted to submit their medical certificate within **seven (7) calendar days** of the examination date. *[2025 Override: Reduced to strictly **5 working days** from exam date or hospital discharge.]*

Clause 5.2 [LEGACY 2023 RULE — SUPERSEDED BY POL-ACAD-AT-02 Clause 2.2 & 3.2]: Under the 2023 Handbook rules, students with medical certificates could receive attendance condonation down to a minimum of **sixty percent (60%)** attendance. *[2025 Override: Raised to **70%–79%** for standard HoD condonation and an absolute **65% hard floor** for Dean's hospitalization waiver.]*

Clause 5.3 [LEGACY 2023 RULE — SUPERSEDED BY POL-ACAD-CW-03 Clause 4.1]: Under the 2023 Handbook rules, unapproved late coursework submissions incurred a penalty of **two percent (2%) per calendar day** for up to 10 days. *[2025 Override: Increased to **5% per working day** for up to 5 working days, with 0% awarded after Day 5.]*

Clause 5.4 [LEGACY 2023 RULE — SUPERSEDED BY POL-ACAD-CW-03 Clause 2.1–2.3]: Under the 2023 Handbook rules, individual module lecturers had discretion to grant coursework extensions of up to **twenty-one (21) days** directly. *[2025 Override: Module Leaders are restricted to **3 working days** (Tier 1), HoDs to 4–7 working days (Tier 2), and Faculty EC Panels to a maximum of **14 calendar days** (Tier 3).]*

Clause 5.5 [LEGACY 2023 RULE — SUPERSEDED BY POL-MED-WF-04 Clause 2.2]: Under the 2023 Handbook rules, private Ayurvedic medical certificates were accepted directly by academic departments without University Medical Center review. *[2025 Override: Private Ayurvedic notes are invalid; only **Government Ayurvedic Teaching Hospital** certificates countersigned by the University CMO within **3 working days** are accepted.]*

Table 5.1: Official Audit Matrix of Legacy 2023 Handbook Rules vs. Binding 2025 Senate Regulations

Conflict ID & Policy Domain	Legacy 2023 Handbook Rule (HBK-ACAD-PR-05 Sec 5)	Binding 2025 Senate Policy Rule (Authoritative)	Superseding Document & Clause	Required Agentic Compliance Resolution
CONFLICT-01: Exam Medical Deadline	7 Calendar Days from examination date (Clause 5.1)	5 Working Days from exam date (or 5 working days post-discharge for inpatients)	POL-ACAD-EX-01 v4.0, Clause 3.2	Enforce 5 working days; flag 7-day handbook rule as superseded
CONFLICT-02: Minimum Attendance Floor	60% Minimum Attendance with medical certificate (Clause 5.2)	70% Standard Condonation / 65% Hard Floor (Inpatient Waiver); <65% Barred	POL-ACAD-AT-02 v3.2, Clauses 2.2, 3.1 & 3.2	Enforce 70% / 65% floors; warn student that 60% rule is obsolete
CONFLICT-03: Coursework Late Penalty	2% deduction per day up to 10 days (Clause 5.3)	5% deduction per working day up to 5 working days; 0% after Day 5	POL-ACAD-CW-03 v3.0, Clauses 4.1 & 4.2	Calculate penalties at 5%/day (max 5 days); reject 2%/day rule
CONFLICT-04: Max Extension Authority	Up to 21 Days approved by Module Lecturer (Clause 5.4)	Tier 1: 3 days (Lecturer); Tier 2: 4–7 days (HoD); Tier 3: Max 14 days (EC Panel)	POL-ACAD-CW-03 v3.0, Clauses 2.1 – 2.3	Route >7 day requests to Faculty EC Panel (Form EXT-03C)
CONFLICT-05: Ayurvedic Certificates	Private Ayurvedic notes accepted directly by department (Clause 5.5)	ONLY Govt. Ayurvedic Teaching Hospital notes + CMO countersignature within 3 working days	POL-MED-WF-04 v3.5, Clause 2.2	Reject private Ayurvedic notes; require Govt Hospital + CMO stamp